

DON'T TAP THE TRAP

Why curiosity can cost you — even from a friend

"It looked like a message from my cousin — just a video link. I clicked it without thinking. Next thing I knew, my account was sending the same link to everyone."

Scammers often hijack Facebook accounts to send malicious links via Messenger. These messages appear to come from someone you know, making them more convincing. Clicking on such links can lead to phishing sites that steal your login credentials or install malware on your device.

Common tactics used in Messenger scams

Be aware of these red flags:

- Messages claiming to be videos of you or shocking news.
- Urgent requests for help or money from friends.
- Links that lead to login pages mimicking Facebook.
- Unexpected messages from friends who don't usually contact you via Messenger.

Protecting yourself and your loved ones

Stay vigilant and take these steps:

- Verify suspicious messages by contacting the friend through another channel.
- Enable two-factor authentication on your Facebook account.
- Regularly update your password and avoid using the same password across multiple sites.
- Educate friends and family about these scams to prevent further spread.

▼ BOTTOM LINE:

A moment of curiosity can compromise your security. Always think before you click, even if the message seems to come from someone you trust.

★ Quick Tips

"Think before you click — even from friends."

Identifying Suspicious Messages

 **Unexpected Links:** Be wary of links that seem out of character or context.

 **Urgent Language:** Messages that create a sense of urgency or fear are red flags.

Securing Your Account

 **Two-Factor Authentication:** Add an extra layer of security to your account.

 **Regular Password Updates:** Change your password periodically and avoid reuse.

Helping Others Stay Safe

 **Spread Awareness:** Inform friends and family about common scams.

 **Report Suspicious Activity:** Use Facebook's tools to report and block scammers.

Further Reading:

- [Protect yourself from phishing on Facebook](#)
- [Avoiding scams on Facebook Messenger](#)
- [Facebook Messenger Scams 2025: How to Spot and Stop Them](#)